

Must-have skills for a Game Designer

- ▶ Writing skills and professional documentation
- ▶ Thorough understanding of gameplay theory (What makes a fun game)
- ▶ Basic visual design and drawing skills (Paint, Basic knowledge of Photoshop etc)
- ▶ Designers must be good presenters and should have excellent communication /presentation skills.
- ▶ Storytelling and narrative development skills.
- ▶ Reasonably fluent in a range of 2D and 3D graphics and animation packages, such as 3D Studio Max or Maya.
- ▶ Good technical knowledge is required, with some programming skills at least at 'scripting' level.
- ▶ Knowledge of a game's target audience and market.
- ▶ Understanding of the capabilities and benefits of different hardware platforms (e.g., PC, console, mobile devices), as well as familiarity with software technologies and techniques appropriate to each platform.
- ▶ They must be able to work both as part of a team and independently.
- ▶ Originality, imagination and creativity.
- ▶ Systematic and strategic thinking.

Systems Designers

The Game Systems Designer is responsible for creating the game systems. He or she refines and maintains a variety of game systems.

What does a Systems Designer do?

- ▶ **Design Systems:** Create and design game systems covering a wide range of gameplay elements such as combat, user interface, levels, win/lose conditions and player objectives.
- ▶ **Define requirements:** Help define the requirements for the design of tools, pipelines, formulas and schemas.
- ▶ **Work with Production Team:** Work closely with members of the Production Team to execute design and work through design revisions as needed. They are responsible for aggressively prototyping and implementing new abilities, systems, and content.
- ▶ **Work with the programming team:** Define AI requirements for NPCs, mobs and bosses.
- ▶ **Review systems of the game:** Iteratively review, tweak and balance game systems.